It isn't necessary to reproduce the full list of directives here, the full list of configuration directives together with their default values and modes can be found at https://www.php.net/manual/en/ini.list.php and we will cover some of the commonly used ones in this section. It is important to know that every directive has a mode which sets where and how it can be defined. The four modes are:

Table 1-1. *`ini` directive modes (documentation only)*

Mode	Description
PHP_INI_USER	Can set with `ini_set()`, in `.user.ini` (CGI/FastCGI only), or the Windows registry
PHP_INI_PERDIR	`php.ini`, `.htaccess`, `.httpd.conf`, `.user.ini`
PHP_INI_SYSTEM	`php.ini`, `httpd.conf`
PHP_INI_ALL	Any of the above

The modes listed above are just labels within the documentation; they don't exist in the run-time language. The official PHP documentation, for example, gives the following information about the directive `post_max_size` (use to control how much data can be received from a client during an HTTP POST request): a default of `8M` (eight megabytes) and a mode of `PHP_INI_PERDIR`. This means it is possible to set different value for `post_max_size` for PHP source code within different directories, you might need one particular URL to handle large file uploads but keep a tighter restriction for the rest, but there is no `PHP_INI_PERDIR` symbol in the language.

Directive Syntax

Directives have the syntax `directive_name = Value` and here's a short excerpt from the default `php.ini` installed onto most systems:

```
; Maximum amount of memory a script may consume
; https://php.net/memory-limit
memory_limit = 256M
```

The default file is actually a very good source of ready information and signposts detailed documentation, as you can see above. Comments are prepended with a semicolon, `;`, the directive name and value are separated by `=`. The example above has